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# HISTORY · The Mauryan Empire: administration, society and Ashoka

**UNDERSTAND IT FIRST**

**What is it?** The Mauryan Empire (about 321–185 BCE) was the **first empire that united most of India** under one ruler, from Afghanistan in the north-west to Karnataka in the south and from Gujarat to Odisha. Its capital was **Pataliputra** (Patna). **Why did it matter?** It created a **large, paid bureaucracy**, a standing army and a tax system, and under **Ashoka** it tried to rule by **Dhamma** (ethical duty) instead of only force. In the exam, learn it as **Sources → Rulers → Politics (administration) → Society → Economy → Religion → Art → Decline**.

## 1. How do we know? The sources

| Source | What it tells |
|---|---|
| **Arthashastra** (Kautilya, also called Chanakya or Vishnugupta) | A book on statecraft, administration, taxes, spies, law. Gives the **Saptanga** theory of the state. Its date and authorship are debated, but it describes Mauryan-type administration. |
| **Indica** (Megasthenes) | Megasthenes was the Greek ambassador of Seleucus Nicator at Chandragupta's court. His book is lost and survives only in quotations of later Greek writers. Describes Pataliputra, the army and city boards. |
| **Mudrarakshasa** (Vishakhadatta) | A Sanskrit play on how Chanakya helped Chandragupta overthrow the Nandas (written much later). |
| **Ashokan inscriptions** | The most reliable source. Mostly in **Brahmi** script and Prakrit; in the north-west in **Kharosthi**, and also **Greek and Aramaic**. Brahmi was deciphered by **James Prinsep in 1837**. Ashoka calls himself **Devanampiya Piyadasi**; the name 'Ashoka' appears in the **Maski** (Karnataka) and Gujarra minor edicts. |
| Others | Buddhist books (**Mahavamsa, Dipavamsa, Divyavadana**), Puranas, Jain books; **Junagadh (Girnar) inscription** of Rudradaman: Chandragupta's governor **Pushyagupta** built the **Sudarshana lake**; Ashoka's governor **Tushaspa** added canals. |

## 2. The rulers, in order

| Ruler | Dates (BCE) | Key facts |
|---|---|---|

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Chandragupta Maurya** | c. 321–297 | With **Chanakya** overthrew the last Nanda king (Dhana Nanda) and founded the empire. Defeated **Seleucus Nicator** (305 BCE); the treaty gave him areas west of the Indus (Arachosia, Gedrosia, Paropamisadae, Aria) in return for 500 elephants. Greek sources call him **Sandrocottus**. Later became a **Jain** monk and, by tradition, died by fasting (sallekhana) at **Shravanabelagola**. |
| **Bindusara** | c. 297–273 | Greeks call him **Amitrochates** (Sanskrit **Amitraghata**, 'slayer of enemies'). Extended the empire in the Deccan. A follower of **Ajivika** sect. Antiochus I sent **Deimachus** as ambassador. |
| **Ashoka** | c. 268–232 | Governor of Ujjain and Taxila earlier. **Kalinga war (261 BCE)**, described in **Rock Edict XIII**: about 1 lakh killed, 1.5 lakh deported. Deep remorse → **Dhamma** and Buddhism. |
| Later Mauryas | 232–185 | Weak successors (Dasharatha, Samprati…). The last, **Brihadratha**, was killed by his commander **Pushyamitra Shunga** in **185 BCE**. |

## 3. Politics: how the empire was ruled

**Saptanga (seven limbs of the state, Arthashastra):** Swami (king), Amatya (ministers), Janapada (territory and people), Durga (fort), Kosha (treasury), Danda (army), Mitra (ally). The king was the head of administration, army and justice, but his power was meant to serve the people's welfare.

Mauryan provinces under the Emperor

| Level | Officials and details |
|---|---|
| Centre | King + **Mantriparishad** (council of ministers) and **Amatyas**. Arthashastra lists **18 Tirthas** (high officers: Mantri, Purohita, Senapati, Yuvaraja…). Many **Adhyakshas** (superintendents) ran departments: agriculture (**Sitadhyaksha**), trade, weights, mines, ships, cows, slaves, etc. |
| Province | **Four provinces** under **Kumaras** (princes) or Aryaputras: Uttarapatha (Taxila), Avantirashtra (Ujjain), Dakshinapatha (Suvarnagiri) and Prachya/Kalinga (Tosali); Magadha at the centre. |
| District, village | Ashokan officers: **Pradeshika** (district head, tax and law), **Rajuka** (land survey and justice), **Yukta** (accounts). **Gramika** headed the village; Arthashastra also mentions **Sthanika** and **Gopa**. |
| City (Megasthenes) | **Pataliputra** had a wooden wall with 64 gates and 570 towers and a moat. City rule by **6 committees of 5 members each**: industry, foreigners, births and deaths, trade, manufactured goods, sale-tax (one-tenth). |
| Army | **6 boards of 5 members** (infantry, cavalry, elephants, chariots, navy, transport): per Pliny, about **6 lakh infantry, 30,000 cavalry, 9,000 elephants**. |
| Spies, justice | **Gudhapurushas** (spies): **sansthan** (stationary) and **sanchari** (wandering). Courts: **Dharmasthiya** (civil) and **Kantakashodhana** (criminal; removing 'thorns'). |

## 4. Ashoka and Dhamma

- **What is Dhamma?** Not a new religion. It is an **ethical code for all people**: tolerance of all sects, non-violence to living beings, respect for parents, elders and teachers, kindness to servants and slaves, generosity to Brahmins and ascetics, truthfulness. Ashoka said it in simple words so that every subject could follow it.
- **How he spread it: Dhamma Mahamatras** (appointed in the 13th year of his reign), **Dhammayatras** (tours instead of hunting trips), **Rajukas** and Pradeshikas touring every 5 years, edicts in local places, hospitals and wells, trees along roads, bans on animal sacrifice and some hunting.
- **Buddhism:** convened the **Third Council at Pataliputra**; sent missions abroad, his son **Mahendra** and daughter **Sanghamitra** to Sri Lanka. Rock Edict XIII names Greek kings (Antiochus, Ptolemy, Antigonus, Magas, Alexander) he sent envoys to.

| Type of edict | Details |
|---|---|
| **Major Rock Edicts (14)** | Girnar, Kalsi, Dhauli, Jaugada, Shahbazgarhi, Mansehra, Sopara, **Erragudi** and others. Edict XIII: Kalinga war. |
| **Minor Rock Edicts** | Maski, Gujarra (name 'Ashoka'), Brahmagiri, Siddapura, Jatinga-Rameshwara, **Rajula Mandagiri**. |
| **Pillar Edicts (7)** | Delhi-Topra, Lauriya Nandangarh, Allahabad (Kausambi), Sarnath, Sanchi. The **Lumbini (Rummindei) pillar** records Ashoka's visit and a tax reduction for the village. |

**EXAMPLE**

**Andhra link (all regions equal):** Ashokan edicts in Andhra Pradesh are at **Erragudi** and **Rajula Mandagiri** (Kurnool district) and a Mauryan-period presence at **Amaravati** (Guntur) and Buddhist sites of the coast. The Mauryan southern limit was roughly the Penna region (Brahmagiri, Siddapura, Maski in Karnataka). Ashoka's thirteenth edict mentions the **Andhras** among the peoples inside his empire.

### 5. Politics · Society · Economy · Religion of the Mauryas

| Area | Mauryan period |
|---|---|
| Politics | **Centralised bureaucratic monarchy**; paid officials; spies; four provinces; Ashoka's paternal rule ('all men are my children'); the first Indian empire. |
| Society | Varna society with **Brahmins and Kshatriyas** on top; Megasthenes wrongly saw 7 classes (philosophers, farmers, soldiers, herdsmen, artisans, magistrates, councillors) and said there was no slavery, while the Arthashastra describes **dasas**. Women: ganikas (courtesans), spies and royal guards; guilds (**shrenis**) of craftsmen. |
| Economy | **State control** of land, mines, salt, trade. Taxes: **bhaga** (about 1/6 of produce), **bali**, tolls, sale tax. Silver **punch-marked coins (pana/karshapana)** checked by **Lakshanadhyaksha/rupyadarsaka**. **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** pottery. Trade routes **Uttarapatha** (Taxila to Pataliputra) and **Dakshinapatha**; ports **Tamralipti, Bharukachchha, Sopara**. Forest and irrigation (Sudarshana lake). |

| | |
|---|---|
| Religion | **Chandragupta** Jain, **Bindusara** Ajivika, **Ashoka** Buddhist but tolerant: he gave the **Barabar caves** to Ajivikas. Brahmanical sacrifices were discouraged by Ashoka. Dhamma was a common ethical code. |

### 6. Mauryan art and decline

- **Court art: polished stone pillars** of Chunar sandstone with animal capitals (lion, bull, elephant), e.g. **Sarnath lion capital**, Rampurva bull, Lauriya Nandangarh lion; **Didarganj Yakshi** (Patna Museum); **Dhauli elephant** (Odisha). **Rock-cut caves: Barabar** and **Nagarjuni** hills (Bihar), the **Lomas Rishi cave**. **Stupas:** the original Sanchi stupa brick core is attributed to Ashoka.
- **Why did it decline?** (1) weak successors after Ashoka; (2) cost of a huge army and bureaucracy (financial strain, shown by debased coins); (3) very large empire with poor communication; (4) oppression by officials in provinces (Taxila revolts); (5) Brahmin dissatisfaction with Ashoka's policy, in one theory; (6) Greek invasions from the north-west; (7) the coup of **Pushyamitra Shunga**. No single cause explains it.

**EXAM TRAP**

Arthashastra: **Kautilya**; Indica: **Megasthenes** (lost, only quotations); Mudrarakshasa: **Vishakhadatta** (not Kalhana, who wrote Rajatarangini). Brahmi deciphered by **Prinsep, 1837**. **Rock Edict XIII = Kalinga war**; the Sarnath **Lion Capital = national emblem**. Chandragupta: **Jain**; Bindusara: **Ajivika**; Ashoka: **Buddhist** (Third Council, Pataliputra). Seleucus defeated **305 BCE**. Last Mauryan killed in **185 BCE**. Tripitaka are Buddhist, not Mauryan administrative texts.

### Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)

**PRACTICE**

**Consider the following statements about the sources for the Mauryan period:**
**1. Megasthenes wrote Indica.**
**2. The Arthashastra is attributed to Kautilya.**
**3. Ashokan Brahmi inscriptions were deciphered by James Prinsep in 1837.**
**4. The Mudrarakshasa was composed by Kalhana.**
**Which of the above are correct?**

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1, 3 and 4 only

C. 2 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Answer: A.** The Mudrarakshasa was written by Vishakhadatta; Kalhana wrote the Rajatarangini.

**PRACTICE**

**Match List-I (ruler) with List-II (feature):**

**List-I: A. Chandragupta Maurya B. Bindusara C. Ashoka D. Brihadratha**

**List-II: 1. Called Amitraghata; followed the Ajivikas 2. Defeated Seleucus Nicator; Jain tradition 3. Kalinga war and Dhamma 4. Killed by Pushyamitra Shunga**

A. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4

B. A-1, B-2, C-3, D-4

C. A-2, B-1, C-4, D-3

D. A-3, B-1, C-2, D-4

**Answer: A.** Chandragupta: Seleucus and Jainism; Bindusara: Amitraghata, Ajivika; Ashoka: Kalinga; Brihadratha: killed by Pushyamitra.

**PRACTICE**

**Which one of the following statements about Ashoka's inscriptions is NOT correct?**

A. Rock Edict XIII describes the Kalinga war.

B. Dhamma Mahamatras were appointed to spread Dhamma.

C. All the inscriptions are written only in the Brahmi script.

D. The Lumbini pillar records Ashoka's visit to the Buddha's birthplace.

**Answer: C.** In the north-west the edicts use Kharosthi, and some are in Greek and Aramaic.

**PRACTICE**

**Assertion (A): The Mauryan state is regarded as highly centralised.**

**Reason (R): The Arthashastra and Megasthenes describe a large paid bureaucracy, spies and committees working under the king's control.**

**Choose the correct answer:**

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

**Answer: A.** The large bureaucracy, spies and boards are exactly why the state is called centralised.

**PRACTICE**

**A scholar reads a text that says a state needs a king, ministers, territory with people, a fort, a treasury, an army and an ally. Which concept does this describe?**

A. Saptanga theory of the state

B. Dhamma of Ashoka

C. Triratna

D. Rajasuya sacrifice

**Answer: A.** Swami, Amatya, Janapada, Durga, Kosha, Danda, Mitra are the seven limbs.

**RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS**

1. Write the Mauryan Politics–Society–Economy–Religion table from memory. 2. List the 4 provinces with capitals and the 3 rulers with one key fact each. 3. Write Dhamma in 5 points and 5 causes of decline.

## POLITY · Fundamental Rights I: Articles 12–19

**UNDERSTAND IT FIRST**

**What is it?** Fundamental Rights (FRs) are basic freedoms and protections in **Part III (Articles 12–35)** that the State cannot take away. They are called 'fundamental' because they are **enforceable in the Supreme Court and High Courts** (unlike Directive Principles). They came from the **USA (Bill of Rights)**; the Constitution lists **six** groups. Today we study **Articles 12–19**: what 'State' means, what happens to laws that break FRs, **Right to Equality** and the **six freedoms**.

The six Fundamental Rights (Part III, Articles 12–35)

**Property** was a Fundamental Right (Art 19(1)(f) and Art 31) until the **44th Amendment (1978)** removed it. It is now only a **legal right** under **Article 300A**.

### 1. Articles 12 and 13: the base

| Article | Meaning | Key points and cases |
|---|---|---|
| **Art 12: 'State'** | The rights are claimed against the 'State'. It includes the **Government and Parliament of India, the Government and Legislature of** | 'Other authorities' (bodies like electricity boards and public corporations) were explained in **Ajay Hasia (1981)**. A purely private person is generally not 'State'. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | **each State, local authorities and other authorities**. | |
| **Art 13: laws against FRs are void** | Any law (including **ordinances, orders, bye-laws, customs**) that goes against an FR is **void to that extent**. This gives the courts the power of **judicial review**. | **Doctrine of eclipse:** an old law that conflicts with an FR is not dead, it is only 'covered' (dormant) and revives if the conflict is removed. **Severability:** only the bad part is struck down. **Art 13(4)** (24th Amendment, 1971): Article 13 does not apply to constitutional amendments under Art 368; later limited by the **basic structure** doctrine (**Kesavananda 1973**). |

## 2. Right to Equality: Articles 14–18

| Article | What it says | Key points |
|---|---|---|
| **Art 14** | **Equality before law** (British idea: no one is above the law) and **equal protection of the laws** (American idea: equals treated equally). | **Reasonable classification** is allowed (different rules for different groups if the difference is related to the aim). Exceptions: **Art 361** (President and Governors not answerable to courts for official acts). Applies to **all persons**. |
| **Art 15** | No discrimination only on grounds of **religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth**; no restriction on access to shops, wells, roads, etc. | **Exceptions: 15(3)** special provisions for **women and children**; **15(4)** for socially and educationally backward classes, SCs and STs (added by the **1st Amendment 1951**, after the Champakam Dorairajan case); **15(5)** (**93rd Amendment 2005**) reservation in educational institutions; **15(6)** (**103rd Amendment 2019**) 10% for **economically weaker sections (EWS)**, upheld by the Supreme Court in 2022 (3:2). |
| **Art 16** | **Equality of opportunity in public employment**: no discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex, descent, place of birth or residence. | **16(4)** reservation for backward classes; **16(4A)** in promotions for SC/ST (**77th Amendment 1995**); **16(4B)** carry-forward of vacancies (**81st, 2000**); **16(6)** EWS. **Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992, Mandal case):** upheld 27% OBC reservation, set a **50% ceiling**, excluded the **creamy layer**, and said no reservation in promotions (later changed by the 77th Amendment). |
| **Art 17** | **Abolition of untouchability**; its practice in any form is an offence. | Laws: **Protection of Civil Rights Act 1955** and the **SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act 1989**. Note: 'untouchability' is not defined in the Constitution. |
| **Art 18** | **Abolition of titles**: the State cannot give titles (except **military and academic distinctions**); citizens cannot accept foreign titles; a foreigner holding office cannot accept one without the President's consent. | **Bharat Ratna, Padma awards** are not 'titles' (**Balaji Raghavan case, 1996**), so they are allowed, but they must not be used as a prefix or suffix to the name. |

## 3. Right to Freedom: Article 19 (six freedoms)

Article 19 gives **citizens only** (not foreigners or companies) six freedoms. A seventh, to hold property (19(1)(f)), was deleted in 1978. All six can be limited by **reasonable restrictions**.

| Clause | Freedom | Note |
|---|---|---|
| 19(1)(a) | **Speech and expression** | Includes **press freedom**, right to know, to remain silent, to broadcast; **Romesh Thappar (1950)**; **Shreya Singhal (2015)** struck down Section 66A of the IT Act. |
| 19(1)(b) | **Assemble peacefully and without arms** | Restriction: public order (Section 144 CrPC type orders). |
| 19(1)(c) | **Form associations, unions or cooperative societies** | **'Cooperative societies'** added by the **97th Amendment 2011**. |
| 19(1)(d) | **Move freely throughout India** | Can be restricted for the interest of the general public and protection of Scheduled Tribes. |
| 19(1)(e) | **Reside and settle in any part of India** | Same restrictions as (d). |
| 19(1)(g) | **Practise any profession, or carry on any occupation, trade or business** | The State may prescribe qualifications or reserve some trades for itself. |

**Grounds for restriction (19(2)):** sovereignty and integrity of India, security of the State, friendly relations with foreign States, **public order** (added by the **1st Amendment 1951**), decency or morality, contempt of court, defamation, incitement to an offence. During a **national emergency** on the ground of **war or external aggression**, the Article 19 freedoms are suspended automatically (**Art 358**).

**EXAMPLE**

Example: a district officer bans a peaceful meeting of farmers saying 'public order' but shows no actual threat. This affects **Art 19(1)(b)**. The restriction must be **reasonable** and based on a real ground in 19(3); court review can strike it down. If the same farmers form a cooperative society, Art 19(1)(c) protects it.

**EXAM TRAP**

**Art 14 applies to all persons**; **Art 19 only to citizens**. Property: deleted from FRs by the **44th Amendment (1978)**, now **Art 300A**. **Cooperatives**: 97th Amendment. **EWS 10%**: 103rd Amendment (Art 15(6), 16(6)). **Indra Sawhney**: 50% ceiling and creamy layer. **Public order** was added to 19(2) by the **1st Amendment**. Art 17 does **not** define untouchability.

**Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)**

**PRACTICE**

**Consider the following statements about Article 13:**

**1. It declares laws inconsistent with Fundamental Rights void to the extent of the inconsistency.**

**2. 'Law' under Article 13 includes ordinances and bye-laws.**

**3. Article 13(4) says that Article 13 does not apply to constitutional amendments under Article 368.**

**4. Under the doctrine of eclipse, a pre-Constitution law that conflicts with a Fundamental Right is void for ever.**

**Which of the above are correct?**

A. 1, 2 and 3 only

B. 1 and 4 only

C. 2, 3 and 4 only

D. 1, 2, 3 and 4

**Answer: A.** Under the doctrine of eclipse the law is only dormant and revives if the conflict is removed, so 4 is wrong.

**PRACTICE**

**Match List-I (Article) with List-II (subject):**

**List-I: A. Article 15 B. Article 16 C. Article 17 D. Article 18**

**List-II: 1. Abolition of untouchability 2. No discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth 3. Equality of opportunity in public employment 4. Abolition of titles**

A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4

B. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4

C. A-2, B-3, C-4, D-1

D. A-1, B-3, C-2, D-4

**Answer: A.** Art 15: no discrimination; Art 16: public employment; Art 17: untouchability; Art 18: titles.

**PRACTICE**

**Which one of the following statements about Article 19 is NOT correct?**

A. It guarantees six freedoms to citizens.

B. The freedom to form cooperative societies was added by the 97th Amendment.

C. The right to hold property was deleted from Article 19 by the 44th Amendment.

D. The freedoms in Article 19 are available to citizens and foreigners alike.

**Answer: D.** Article 19 rights are only for citizens; Art 14 is for all persons.

**PRACTICE**

**Assertion (A): The Supreme Court has generally held that reservations should not exceed 50%.**
**Reason (R): In Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992) the Court held that reservation under Article 16(4) should not normally go beyond 50%, except in extraordinary situations.**
**Choose the correct answer:**

A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A

B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A

C. A is true but R is false

D. A is false but R is true

**Answer: A.** R states the 1992 ruling that created the 50% ceiling mentioned in A.

**PRACTICE**

**The authorities of a district ban a peaceful public meeting of farmers on the ground of 'public order', without showing any real threat. Which provision is most directly affected, and what test must the restriction meet?**

A. Article 19(1)(b): the restriction must be reasonable and based on a ground in Article 19(3)

B. Article 25: it must be approved by the President

C. Article 19(1)(d): it must be passed by Parliament

D. Article 17: it must not involve untouchability

**Answer: A.** Freedom of peaceful assembly is Art 19(1)(b); restrictions must be reasonable and fall within the grounds of Art 19(3).

**RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS**

1. Draw the six Fundamental Rights with article numbers. 2. Write Articles 14–18 in one line each, with one exception for each where possible. 3. List the six freedoms of Article 19 and the grounds of restriction.

## REASONING · Blood relations

**UNDERSTAND IT FIRST**

**What is it?** A blood-relation question gives a few facts such as 'A is the brother of B' and asks how two persons are related. **The secret:** do not solve it in your head. **Draw a small family tree**: use **+ for male, − for female, = for married**, a horizontal line for brothers and sisters, and a vertical line for parent to child. Then read the link between the two persons.

| Relation | Name |
|---|---|
| Father's or mother's father/mother | Grandfather / Grandmother |
| Father's brother | Paternal uncle (chacha) |
| Mother's brother | Maternal uncle (mama) |
| Father's sister / Mother's sister | Paternal aunt (bua) / Maternal aunt (mausi) |
| Children of uncle or aunt | Cousins |
| Brother's or sister's son / daughter | Nephew / Niece |
| Spouse's father / mother | Father-in-law / Mother-in-law |
| Spouse's brother / sister, sister's husband | Brother-in-law / Sister-in-law |
| Son's wife / Daughter's husband | Daughter-in-law / Son-in-law |

| Type | Example | Solution |
|---|---|---|
| Direct chain | A is the brother of B. B is the sister of C. C is the father of D. How is A related to D? | A, B, C are siblings; C is D's father, so A is D's father's brother: **paternal uncle**. |
| 'Pointing to' type | Pointing to a man, a woman says, 'His mother is the only daughter of my mother.' How is the woman related to the man? | My mother's only daughter = **myself**. So his mother is me: she is his **mother**. |
| Coded relation | 'A + B' means A is the mother of B; 'A − B' means A is the brother of B. In 'P + Q − R', how is R related to P? | P is the mother of Q; Q is the brother of R. So R is P's **child** (son or daughter). |

**EXAM TRAP**

Do not assume gender: 'cousin', 'sibling', 'spouse', 'child' do not tell male or female. If the gender cannot be found, the answer may be 'cannot be determined'. 'Only son' or 'only daughter' limits the number of children, which is useful for the chain.

**Test yourself: 5 questions (tap an option to see the answer)**

**PRACTICE**

**Pointing to a man, Rani said, "His mother is the only daughter of my mother." How is Rani related to the man?**

A. Mother

B. Sister

C. Aunt

D. Grandmother

**Answer: A.** The only daughter of Rani's mother is Rani herself, so she is the man's mother.

**PRACTICE**

**A is the brother of B. B is the sister of C. C is the father of D. How is A related to D?**

A. Uncle

B. Father

C. Brother

D. Cousin

**Answer: A.** A and C are siblings, so A is the brother of D's father: a paternal uncle.

**PRACTICE**

**A man says to a woman, "Your mother's husband's sister is my wife." How is the woman related to the man?**

A. Niece

B. Daughter

C. Sister

D. Cousin

**Answer: A.** Her mother's husband is her father; his sister (her paternal aunt) is the man's wife. So the woman is the man's wife's niece, that is, his niece.

**PRACTICE**

**P is the brother of Q. R is the mother of P. S is the father of Q. T is the brother of S. U is the daughter of T. How is U related to R?**

A. Niece

B. Daughter

C. Sister

D. Cousin

**Answer: A.** R and S are Q's parents (R is the wife of S). T is S's brother, U is T's daughter, so U is the niece of S and of R.

**PRACTICE**

**Pointing to a lady, a man said, "The son of her only brother is the brother of my wife." How is the lady related to the man?**

A. Sister of father-in-law

B. Mother of wife's brother

C. Sister of wife

D. Aunt

**Answer: A.** The lady's brother's son is the wife's brother, so the lady's brother is the wife's father. The lady is the sister of the man's father-in-law.

**RECALL BOX: CLOSE THE NOTES AND WRITE THESE IN YOUR OWN WORDS**

1. Write the relation chart (uncle, aunt, cousin, in-laws). 2. Write the symbol method (+, −, =) and draw the tree for Q3 above. 3. Make two of your own questions and solve them.

## NOTEBOOK PAGE · Day 4: write this from memory

Close the notes. Write these headings, fill every blank, then correct in a different colour.

### HISTORY: Mauryas, Politics · Society · Economy · Religion

| Area | Write |
|---|---|
| Sources | Arthashastra (Kautilya), Indica (Megasthenes), Mudrarakshasa (Vishakhadatta), Ashokan inscriptions (Prinsep 1837), Mahavamsa, Junagadh inscription |

| | |
|---|---|
| Rulers | Chandragupta 321–297 (Seleucus 305, Jain, Shravanabelagola); Bindusara (Amitraghata, Ajivika); Ashoka 268–232 (Kalinga 261, Dhamma); last Brihadratha killed 185 BCE by Pushyamitra |
| Politics | Saptanga; Mantriparishad, Amatyas, Adhyakshas; 4 provinces (Taxila, Ujjain, Suvarnagiri, Tosali) under Kumaras; Pradeshika, Rajuka, Yukta; spies; Megasthenes' 6 city and 6 army boards of 5; Dhamma Mahamatras |
| Society | Varna society; Megasthenes' 7 classes; women (ganikas, spies, guards); slavery (dasas) in Arthashastra; guilds (shrenis) |
| Economy | State control; land revenue bhaga (1/6), bali; Sitadhyaksha; punch-marked silver pana, rupyadarsaka; NBPW; trade routes Uttarapatha/Dakshinapatha; ports Tamralipti, Bharukachchha, Sopara |
| Religion | Chandragupta Jain; Bindusara Ajivika; Ashoka Buddhist (3rd Council, missions, Mahendra, Sanghamitra); Dhamma = ethical code, toleration; Barabar caves to Ajivikas |
| Art, decline | Polished pillars, Sarnath lion capital, stupas, Barabar caves, Didarganj yakshi; decline: weak successors, cost of army and bureaucracy, vast size, coup |

### POLITY: Fundamental Rights I (Arts 12–19)

- Part III, Arts 12–35, six rights (draw the six boxes with articles). Property removed by 44th Amend. 1978 (now Art 300A).
- Art 12 State; Art 13 void laws (eclipse, severability, 13(4)); Art 14 equality before law + equal protection (reasonable classification); Art 15 (15(3), 15(4) 1st Amend., 15(5) 93rd, 15(6) 103rd EWS); Art 16 (16(4), 16(4A) 77th, Indra Sawhney 1992, 50%); Art 17 untouchability; Art 18 titles.
- Art 19(1)(a)–(g) six freedoms (list them); reasonable restrictions: sovereignty and integrity, security, friendly relations, public order, decency, contempt, defamation, incitement; only for citizens.

### REASONING: Blood relations

Write the relation chart (father's/mother's brother and sister, cousin, in-laws), the sign method (+ male, – female, = married) and the 3-step method: draw → mark generations → read the link. Solve one example of each: direct, 'pointing to' and coded.